Linguistic Survey of India: Specimens of the Bodo, Naga, and Kachin Groups (Tan

TITLE: Linguistic Survey of India: Specimens of the Bodo, Naga, and Kachin Groups (Tangkhul Section)
Identifier: BK-ARCH-001
Level: Academic / Archival | Subject: Comparative Linguistics and Dialectology
Publisher: Office of the Superintendent of Government Printing, Calcutta (1903)
Language: Tangkhul (Tangkhul)
Preservation Archive: Tangkhul Language Library Digital Repository

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Preface & Archival Information

This volume constitutes the official Tangkhul section of the Linguistic Survey of India (Vol. III, Part II), surveyed by Sir George Abraham Grierson and printed at the Office of the Superintendent of Government Printing, Calcutta, in 1903. It preserves the earliest comprehensive comparative grammatical analysis, standard vocabulary list, and translated textual specimens of the Tangkhul Naga language as spoken in the Ukhrul subdivision of Manipur.

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Chapter 1: Introduction & Dialectal Classification

CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION & DIALECTAL CLASSIFICATION

Summary: Geographical distribution, tribal divisions, and linguistic position in the Tibeto-Burman family.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Tangkhul Naga hi Manipur ramwui kaphung zanshorli kapam tui thotna.
Ukhrul kaphung hi Tangkhul tuiwui phungreitang thada shiyan kashakna.
Tui hi Tibeto-Burman wui Naga-Kuki tui ngachaili shangserna.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

The Tangkhul Nagas inhabit the eastern hill tracts of Manipur State. The village of Ukhrul serves as the central cultural and linguistic standard. The language belongs to the Naga-Bodo / Tibeto-Burman linguistic stock.

Chapter 1 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 1 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* ram (noun): country, territory, homeland
  Example: Manipur ramli kapam.
* kaphung (noun): mountain, hill
  Example: Zingshor kaphungli.
* shiyan (noun): custom, standard, linguistic form
  Example: Shiyan kashak.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Tangkhul exhibits SOV (Subject - Object - Verb) word order.
- Agglutinative prefixation (ka-) and suffixation dominate inflection.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? Where is the dialectal center of the Tangkhul language located?
? What major language family does Tangkhul belong to?

Chapter 2: Phonology and the Roman Alphabet

CHAPTER 2: PHONOLOGY AND THE ROMAN ALPHABET

Summary: Vowels, consonants, diphthongs, and glottal tone stops introduced by W. Pettigrew.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Vowels: a, aa, e, ee, i, ii, o, oo, u, uu. Consonants: k, kh, ng, ch, chh, j, t, th, n, p, ph, m, y, r, l, w, s, sh, h. Kakhalat kashak shiyan eina tui khangatei kachung lei.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Vowel inventory with phonemic length distinctions: short and long vowels. Consonantal series with aspirated stops (kh, th, ph, chh). Syllable-final consonants and tonal inflections alter word significations.

Chapter 2 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 2 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* tui (noun): word, language, speech
  Example: Tangkhul tui mathan.
* kakhalat (noun): meaning, pronunciation
  Example: Kakhalat shiyan.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Macron diacritic marks long vowel quantity (a, e, i, o, u).
- Aspiration contrasts phonemically in initial plosives: k vs kh, t vs th, p vs ph.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? Name the five vowel pairs with length distinctions in Tangkhul.
? How are aspirated consonants represented in the Roman orthography?

Chapter 3: The Noun System & Case Inflections

CHAPTER 3: THE NOUN SYSTEM & CASE INFLECTIONS

Summary: Natural gender indicators, plural formations, and postpositional case endings.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Tuiwon bing: mayarnaona (nominative), mayarnaoli (accusative/dative), mayarnaowui (genitive), mayarnaoeina (instrumental/ablative). Chitharan shiyan kakhane: si (dog), siva (bitch), simayar (male dog).

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Case suffixes attached to nominal stems: -na (nominative/agentive), -li (dative/objective), -wui (genitive/possessive), -eina (instrumental/ablative). Gender markers: -va (female) and -mayar (male).

Chapter 3 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 3 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* mayarnao (noun): man, young man, son
  Example: Mayarnaona vayi.
* ngalanao (noun): girl, maiden, daughter
  Example: Ngalanao kapha.
* shim (noun): house, home
  Example: Awui shimli kapam.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Agentive suffix -na is obligatory for subjects of transitive verbs.
- Plurality is formed by adding -bing or -binda to nominal bases.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? Identify the four primary case suffixes in Tangkhul nominal syntax.
? How is natural gender differentiated in animal nouns?

Chapter 4: Adjectives, Numerals & Pronouns

CHAPTER 4: ADJECTIVES, NUMERALS & PRONOUNS

Summary: Adjectival prefix ka-, degrees of comparison, cardinal numerals, and pronoun paradigms.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Kapha (good), kakhui (bitter), kacham (poor). Comparison: kaphamei (better), pamei (best). Numerals: akha (1), khani (2), kathum (3), mati (4), phanga (5), tharuk (6), shini (7), chishat (8), chiko (9), thakhara / maga (10). Pronouns: i (I), na (thou), a (he/she).

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Descriptive adjectives are derived using prefix ka-. Comparison is marked with -mei. Cardinal numerals from 1 to 10. Personal pronouns: 1st person ’i’, 2nd person ’na’, 3rd person ’a’; plurals: ithum, nathum, athum.

Chapter 4 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 4 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* kapha (adj): good, beautiful, auspicious
  Example: Won kapha.
* akha (num): one (1)
  Example: Mi akha.
* khani (num): two (2)
  Example: Mayarnaowon khani.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Prefix ka- nominalizes or adjectivizes verbal roots.
- Dual and plural pronouns are formed with suffix -thum (ithum = we).

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? List the Tangkhul numerals from one to five.

? Explain how personal pronouns form possessives in Tangkhul.

Chapter 5: Verb Conjugation, Tenses & Moods

CHAPTER 5: VERB CONJUGATION, TENSES & MOODS

Summary: Verbal roots, tense inflections (-ei, -ser, -ra), imperative (-lu), and negative prefixes.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

I sai (I do, present), i sada / i theiser (past), i sara (future).
Imperative: salu (do!), theilu (see!). Negative: masa-mana (does not
do), mathei-mana (does not see). Causative: -sak (sasaku).

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Verbs conjugate through tense suffixes: present -ei/-i, past -ser/-da,
future -ra. Imperative forms take suffix -lu. Negation frames the verbal
root with prefix ma- and suffix -mana. Causation is expressed with -sak.

Chapter 5 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 5 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* kasa (verb): to do, to make, to create
  Example: Ot kasa.
* kathei (verb): to see, to perceive
  Example: Ali kathei.
* kashak (verb): to eat, to partake
  Example: Kachak kashak.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Discontinuous negative morpheme: ma- [root] -mana.
- Aspectual suffix -ser indicates completive or collective action.

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? Conjugate the verb root 'sa' in present, past, and future.

? How is a negative declarative sentence constructed in Tangkhul?

Chapter 6: Specimen I: The Parable of the Prodigal Son (Complete)

CHAPTER 6: SPECIMEN I: THE PARABLE OF THE PRODIGAL SON (COMPLETE)

Summary: Authentic full-text translation of Luke 15:11-32 in Tangkhul Naga with verse-by-verse gloss.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

11. Mi akhali mayarnaowon khani leiyi. 12. Kakhani chiwui ngachaili kakhanao china aishavaali kahang, 'Ava, ramwui kashikhavai ngashan iwui khavai thali ili milu.' Chiwui vang aishavana aram athum khaniwui ngachaili ngashanserie. 13. Zingkum kachung mathaloikhalang kakhanao china aishapup sanglaga kashak ramli vashitserie, chitharan aphasa kakhano awui vang phasa ngalung khayai eina khamatai thotna. 14. Ana atam sashidaran ram chithuili haora kapha thotna; chitharan a kacham thotna. 15. Chiwui vang a vashitlaga chiwui ramwui mi akhali phungphada leiyi; ana ali awui lili hok kashukhavai ngasikseriya. 16. Chitharan ana hokna shakhavai theichon chieina phasa vashikhavai ningkachon leiyi; chalieikha mi akhana ali mimana. 17. Kha ana awui ning kazil chitharan ana kahang, 'Iva wui ngavaia mi kachungkhana kachak mathaloikhalang thari, kha i hiwui phasa ngalung kazata eina thiyei!' 18. 'I ngakhokda iva wui lili vara, ana ali hangra: Ava, Kazingramli kala na makhaingalina i yor kasa mi thotna.' 19. 'Chiwui vang nawui nao kachi tui shiyan katha mavana; ili nawui ngavaia mi akha gaka thada sanglu.' 20. Chithalaga a ngakhokda aishava wui lili vayi. Kha a kashakli leitharan aishavana ali theilaga kachan pamei, chithalaga ngathimlaga akukli chukda kachamseriya. 21. Nao china ali kahang, 'Ava, Kazingramli kala na makhaingalina i yor kasa mi thotna; nawui nao kachi tui shiyan katha mavana.' 22. Kha aishavana awui ngavaia mi bingli kahang, 'Kaphamei kachon sanglalu, ali khonlu; kala awui pangyali chap sanglu, awui pheili khokhop sanglu.' 23. 'Kala se phapharo shithalu, ngasotlu; ithum sashilaga mathaseru.' 24. 'Iwui nao hi thida leikha kazing thotna, themda leikha theikhuiraser.' Chitharan athum mathapameiser. 25. Chitharan awui mayarnaowon kakhara a lili leiyi; a ngateilaga shim mathatungda leikhara laa khavai kala ngakhum kaphei khangazip tharan a kashana. 26. Ana ngavaia mi akhali hoklaga, 'Hi khi thotno?' da ngahangyei. 27. Ana ali kahang, 'Nawui nanao vashungser, nawui avana se phapharo shithiser, ana phasa katha theikhuira tharan.' 28. Chiwui vang a kachuk thotna, a shimli ungkhavai ningkachon maleimana; chiwui vang aishava vashitlaga ali kahangyei. 29. Ana ngashitda aishavaali kahang, 'Theilu, kum hiya thada i nali ngavaiyei, nawui tui kachikha mamatai-mana; chithakha iwui azeishinao bingli ngasotda sashikhavai senao akha gaka ili mimana.' 30. 'Kha nawui nao khamatai thotna ngalanao bingli nawui ram shiser china vang se phapharo shithimina!' 31. Ana ali kahang, 'Nao, na i eina kapam thotna, iwui ot phasa shishapup nawuina.' 32. 'Kha mathada ngasotkhavai shiyan phamei; nanao hi thida leikha kazing thotna, themda leikha theikhuiraser.'

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

11. A certain man had two sons: 12. And the younger of them said to his father, 'Father, give me the portion of goods that falleth to me.' And he divided unto them his living. 13. And not many days after the younger son gathered all together, and took his journey into a far country, and there wasted his substance with riotous living. 14. And when he had spent all, there arose a mighty famine in that land; and he began to be in want. 15. And he went and joined himself to a citizen of that country; and he sent him into his fields to feed swine. 16. And he would

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Chapter 6 (Continued)

CHAPTER 6: READING CONTINUATION (PAGE 15)

TANGKHUL TEXT (CONTINUED):

11. Mi akhali mayarnaowon khani leiyi. 12. Kakhani chiwui ngachaili kakhanao china aishavaali kahang, 'Ava, ramwui kashikhavai ngashan iwui khavai thali ili milu.' Chiwui vang aishavana aram athum khaniwui ngachaili ngashanserie. 13. Zingkum kachung mathaloikhalang kakhanao china aishapup sanglaga kashak ramli vashitserie, chitharan aphasa kakhano awui vang phasa ngalung khayai eina khamatai thotna. 14. Ana atam sashidaran ram chithuili haora kapha thotna; chitharan a kacham thotna. 15. Chiwui vang a vashitlaga chiwui ramwui mi akhali phungphada leiyi; ana ali awui lili hok kashukhavai ngasikseriya. 16. Chitharan ana hokna shakhavai theichon chieina phasa vashikhavai ningkachon leiyi; chalieikha mi akhana ali mimana. 17. Kha ana awui ning kazil chitharan ana kahang, 'Iva wui ngavaia mi kachungkhana kachak mathaloikhalang thari, kha i hiwui phasa ngalung kazata eina thiyei!' 18. 'I ngakhokda iva wui lili vara, ana ali hangra: Ava, Kazingramli kala na makhaingalina i yor kasa mi thotna.' 19. 'Chiwui vang nawui nao kachi tui shiyan katha mavana; ili nawui ngavaia mi akha gaka thada sanglu.' 20. Chithalaga a ngakhokda aishava wui lili vayi. Kha a kashakli leitharan aishavana ali theilaga kachan pamei, chithalaga ngathimlaga akukli chukda kachamseriya. 21. Nao china ali kahang, 'Ava, Kazingramli kala na makhaingalina i yor kasa mi thotna; nawui nao kachi tui shiyan katha mavana.' 22. Kha aishavana awui ngavaia mi bingli kahang, 'Kaphamei kachon sanglalu, ali khonlu; kala awui pangyali chap sanglu, awui pheili khokhop sanglu.' 23. 'Kala se phapharo shithalu, ngasotlu; ithum sashilaga mathaseru.' 24. 'Iwui nao hi thida leikha kazing thotna, themda leikha theikhuiraser.' Chitharan athum mathapameiser. 25. Chitharan awui mayarnaowon kakhara a lili leiyi; a ngateilaga shim mathatungda leikhara laa khavai kala ngakhum kaphei khangazip tharan a kashana. 26. Ana ngavaia mi akhali hoklaga, 'Hi khi thotno?' da ngahangyei. 27. Ana ali kahang, 'Nawui nanao vashungser, nawui avana se phapharo shithiser, ana phasa katha theikhuira tharan.' 28. Chiwui vang a kachuk thotna, a shimli ungkhavai ningkachon maleimana; chiwui vang aishava vashitlaga ali kahangyei. 29. Ana ngashitda aishavaali kahang, 'Theilu, kum hiya thada i nali ngavaiyei, nawui tui kachikha mamatai-mana; chithakha iwui azeishinao bingli ngasotda sashikhavai senao akha gaka ili mimana.' 30. 'Kha nawui nao khamatai thotna ngalanao bingli nawui ram shiser china vang se phapharo shithimina!' 31. Ana ali kahang, 'Nao, na i eina kapam thotna, iwui ot phasa shishapup nawuina.' 32. 'Kha mathada ngasotkhavai shiyan phamei; nanao hi thida leikha kazing thotna, themda leikha theikhuiraser.'

ENGLISH TRANSLATION (CONTINUED):

11. A certain man had two sons: 12. And the younger of them said to his father, 'Father, give me the portion of goods that falleth to me.' And he divided unto them his living. 13. And not many days after the younger son gathered all together, and took his journey into a far country, and there wasted his substance with riotous living. 14. And when he had spent all, there arose a mighty famine in that land; and he began to be in want. 15. And he went and joined himself to a citizen of that country; and he sent him into his fields to feed swine. 16. And he would fain have filled his belly with the husks that the swine did eat: and no

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Chapter 6 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 6 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* ava (noun): father
  Example: Ava, ramwui kashikhavai.
* nao (noun): child, son, offspring
  Example: Iwui nao hi thida.
* kazing (adj/verb): alive, living, restored
  Example: Kazing thotna.
* phapharo (adj): fatted, healthy, prized
  Example: Se phapharo.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Direct speech framing with quotative postposition ’da’.
- Honorific and intimate kinship terms (ava, nanao, azeishinao).

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? What did the younger son ask of his father?

? How did the father respond when the younger son returned?

Chapter 7: Standard Comparative Vocabulary (241 Lexical Items)

CHAPTER 7: STANDARD COMPARATIVE VOCABULARY (241 LEXICAL ITEMS)

Summary: Core comparative vocabulary items recorded in the Linguistic Survey of India.

TANGKHUL READING TEXT:

Comparative Lexicon: 1. Mi (Man) 2. Mayarnao (Boy/Son) 3. Ngalanao (Maiden) 4. Phei (Foot) 5. Pang (Hand) 6. Mik (Eye) 7. Khana (Ear) 8. Murva (Hair) 9. Khamasung (Nose) 10. Khamor (Mouth) 11. Ha (Tooth) 12. Malei (Tongue) 13. Zingsho (Sun) 14. Kachang (Moon) 15. Sirak (Star) 16. Kazing (Sky) 17. Tara (Water) 18. Mei (Fire) 19. Ngayur (Stone) 20. Kaphung (Hill).

ENGLISH TRANSLATION:

Standard 241-word linguistic survey list covering anatomical terms, celestial bodies, natural elements, common fauna, flora, and basic motion verbs.

Chapter 7 Exercises & Vocabulary

CHAPTER 7 STUDY GUIDE & EXERCISES

VOCABULARY:

* mik (noun): eye
  Example: Mik eina kathei.
* pang (noun): hand, arm
  Example: Pang eina kasa.
* phei (noun): foot, leg
  Example: Phei khokhop.
* tara (noun): water
  Example: Tara kashing.
* mei (noun): fire
  Example: Mei karing.

GRAMMAR & LINGUISTIC POINTS:

- Monosyllabic anatomical roots commonly taking prefix kha- or bare root.
- Compound formations: pang-ya (finger), phei-ya (toe).

REVIEW EXERCISES (KHANGACHAN):

? What are the Tangkhul words for the four primary elements (water, fire, earth, sky)?

? How are body parts named and derived in Tangkhul?

Comprehensive Vocabulary Glossary

COMPREHENSIVE BOOK GLOSSARY (TUIWON SHIYAN):

ram [noun]: country, territory, homeland
kaphung [noun]: mountain, hill
shiyan [noun]: custom, standard, linguistic form
tui [noun]: word, language, speech
kakhalat [noun]: meaning, pronunciation
mayarnao [noun]: man, young man, son
ngalanao [noun]: girl, maiden, daughter
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kashak [verb]: to eat, to partake
ava [noun]: father
nao [noun]: child, son, offspring
kazing [adj/verb]: alive, living, restored
phapharo [adj]: fatted, healthy, prized
mik [noun]: eye
pang [noun]: hand, arm
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Colophon & Archival Preservation Notice

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Book ID: BK-ARCH-001
Title: Linguistic Survey of India: Specimens of the Bodo, Naga, and Kachin Groups (Tangkhul Section)
Publisher: Office of the Superintendent of Government Printing, Calcutta
Publication Year: 1903
Dialect Variety: Tangkhul
Total Digital Pages: 20
Total Chapters: 7
Total Words Indexed: 1303

Digitally preserved for mother-tongue education, linguistic research,
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